

CEE 260/MIE 273
Probability and Statistics in Engineering
Fall 2026 Course Syllabus

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1 Personnel and Logistics

1.1 Venue and Class Time

All classes will be held Engineering Lab II Room 119. They will also be recorded and available for download via Canvas (using Echo360). You are expected to attend all lectures, except by prior notification. I will also upload slides in advance of each lecture. Periodically, I will also make typeset notes available to you, particularly for exam review sessions. I encourage you to use the Canvas Forum for discussions on homework, problem sets and other academic/course matters.

Day & Time: Tuesdays & Thursdays 1:00PM – 2:15PM

Physical Location: ELab II Room 119

Gradescope Entry Code: WDBYPK

Project Presentations: Monday, December 21 (1:00PM – 3:00PM)

1.2 Instructor

Name: Dr. Jimi Oke¹

Email: jimi@umass.edu

Office: Sustainable Engineering Laboratories 2M32

Office Hours: Tuesdays and Wednesdays (2:30 – 3:30PM)

1.3 Teaching Assistant

The Teaching Assistant will be responsible for coordinating the course and holding additional office hours for homework help.

Name: Mohammed Abdalazeem

Email: mamohammed@umass.edu

Tutorials: TBD

1.4 Grader

The grader will be responsible for evaluating and assigning grades to problem sets:

- Rillary Madruga Ferreira

2 Course Information

2.1 Description

The Probability and Statistics in Engineering course is designed to introduce students to the field of probability and statistics, and demonstrate its importance and utility in the solution of problems specifically of interest to civil, environmental, mechanical and industrial engineering. Core areas covered by this course are

- basic probability concepts
- the role of uncertainty in engineering design
- sampling and inference (hypothesis testing, confidence intervals, ANOVA)
- probability distribution model fitting and testing
- regression and correlation analyses

¹Pronounced “aw-KEH”; Pronouns: He/Him/His

2.2 Objectives

CEE 260/MIE 273 aims to introduce you to statistical methods in engineering and develop your ability to analytically apply these methods in your practice of engineering.

2.3 Outcomes

In this course, you will:

- Understand the fundamental concepts of probability, such as independence, expectation, error propagation, and density functions.
- Identify, apply and evaluate the proper probability model for different systems.
- Use statistical methods to describe processes and make inferences about systems from data.
- Perform regression analyses, test hypotheses, and calculate confidence intervals for solving engineering problems.
- Develop and apply computational and numerical approaches to quantify uncertainty.
- Gain proficiency with Python for statistical analysis.

2.4 Textbook

Required Text: Diez, David, Cetinkaya-Rundel, Mine, and Barr, Christopher. OpenIntro Statistics (4th Ed.) 2019. <https://leanpub.com/openintro-statistics>

Supplementary Reading: William Navidi. Statistics for Engineers and Scientists. Fifth Edition, McGraw-Hill Education 2020.

Other resource: Kunin et al. Seeing Theory (<https://seeing-theory.brown.edu/index.html>)

2.5 Prerequisite

MATH 132 (or equivalent).

3 Policies

My goal is to introduce you to the rudiments of probability and statistics within an engineering context. I will use slides in the classroom, and annotate them electronically when possible. These slides will be available to you prior to the lecture. I will endeavor to foster an equitable and inclusive learning environment that will spark your curiosity and challenge you learn actively. I strongly urge you to come to class prepared, having done the reading, ready to reflect on your homework or problem set and engage with new material. I will ask frequent questions of you, and will also expect you to ask as many questions as possible. Further specifics on class policies and values are as follows.

3.1 Overview of Assessments

You will be evaluated based on your in-class activities, problem sets, a midterm and a project. See [Table 1](#) for a breakdown of the grades. Students are assessed individually, and there is no pre-determined grade spread in any subject. Consistent with this, after drop date, students who remain in this class are not in jeopardy of seeing their grades change due to the change in class composition. There will be no grading on a curve. Individual grades will be based on the scale shown in [Table 2](#).

TABLE 1 Course components and grade breakdown

Assessment	Number	Unit %	Total %	Explanation
In-Class Activities	23	1	20	3 absences excused
Problem Sets [PS]	10	3.5	35	
Labs [LAB]	10	2	20	
Midterm Exam	1	10	8	
Final Project	1	20	17	
TOTAL			100	

TABLE 2 Grading scale

Grade	Range (%)
A	93–100%
A–	90–92
B+	87–89
B	83–86
B–	80–82
C+	77–79
C	73–76
C–	70–72
D	60–69
F	≤ 60

3.2 In-class activities

During each lecture (there are 24 this semester), there will be an activity to be completed either individually or in a group. Activities will include surveys, short readings, interactive quizzes/polls and/or worksheets. In order to participate fully, **please bring your laptop to all lectures**.

3.3 Problem sets and LABs

Problem sets (PS) will be assigned weekly and due on Tuesdays at 12:59pm submitted via Gradescope. Solutions will be posted after the due date. In addition you will typically be assigned a LAB which includes a guided Python problem (provided as a Google Colab Notebook) with clearly stated objectives. In each case, the steps will be laid out as clearly as possible. You should be able to complete these without further external guidance. These assignments will enable you master some key probabilistic and statistical functions in Python, along with practice in visualization. You will also practice applying a concept you learned in class while completing these assignments. In each LAB, you will be required to submit a `.ipynb` (Google Colab Notebook) with your responses. Instructions will be clearly laid out on each assignment, so please follow them to a T. This will ensure that your work can be efficiently and fairly evaluated.

NOTE: **Late problem sets will not be graded**, excepting emergencies or illness (of which adequate proof must be provided) or **prior permission** for exigencies (with requests made *no later than the Sunday before the due date*).

3.4 Exam

The mid-term will be conducted as a take-home open-book exam. You will typically have 2 hours to complete it. It will be submitted as a PDF document.

3.5 Project

The project will be a structured assignment focused on linear regression. You will execute this in a group of 5 students. More detailed instructions will be provided after the mid-term. Deliverables will include a proposal, a report and a presentation.

4 Schedule

The table below summarizes the schedule of topics, reading and assignments for this course. Please study carefully. Let me or the TA know promptly if you have any questions.

Date	Module	Topic	Reading	Assignments
M1 Introduction				
Tu, Sep 8	1A	Data and Sampling	1	(No in-person class) PS 1 & LAB 1 due
Th, Sep 10	1B	Summarizing Data	2	
Tu, Sep 15	1C	Case Studies and Experiments	2	
M2 Probability				
Th, Sep 17	2A	Events & Set Operations	3.1	PS 2 & LAB 2 due
Tu, Sep 22	2B	Theory of Probability	3.2	
Th, Sep 24	2C	Conditional Probability & Bayes' Theorem	3.3-4	
M3 Probability Distributions				
Tu, Sep 29	3A	Introduction	3.5	PS 3 & LAB 3 due
Th, Oct 1	3B	Normal Distribution	4.1	PS 4 & LAB 4 due
Tu, Oct 6	3C	Lognormal and Exponential Distributions	TBD	
Th, Oct 8	3D	Binomial Distribution	4.3	
Tu, Oct 13	3E	Poisson Distribution	4.5	PS 5 & LAB 5 due
Th, Oct 15	3F	Review/Applications		
Tu, Oct 20		MIDTERM EXAM (Take Home: 2hrs)		
M4 Inference Foundations				
Th, Oct 22	4A	Point Estimates	5.1	PS 6 & LAB 6 due
Tu, Oct 27	4B	Sampling Variability & Central Limit Thm	5.1	
Th, Oct 29	4C	Confidence Intervals for a Proportion	5.2	
Tu, Nov 3		NO CLASS (Election Day)		
Th, Nov 5	4D	Hypothesis Testing for a Proportion	5.3	
M5 Inference for Categorical Data				
Tu, Nov 10	5A	Inference for Single Proportion	6.1	PS 7 & LAB 7 due
Th, Nov 12	5B	Difference of Two Proportions	6.2	PS 8 & LAB 8 due
Tu, Nov 17	5C	Goodness of Fit Testing (Chi-square)	6.3-4	
M6 Inference for Numerical Data				
Th, Nov 19	6A	One-sample means	7.1	PS 9 & LAB 9 due
Tu, Nov 24		NO CLASS (Wednesday schedule followed)		
Th, Nov 26		THANKSGIVING RECESS		
Tu, Dec 1	6B	Inference with Two Samples	7.2-3	
Th, Dec 3	6C	Power and ANOVA	7.4-5	
M7 Linear Regression				
Tu, Dec 8	7A	Correlation and Least Squares	8.1-2	PS10 & LAB10 due
Th, Dec 10	7B	Inference for Regression	8.4, 9.1-4	
Tu, Dec 15		Review & Project Q&A		
Mo, Dec 21		PROJ. PRESENTATIONS (1:00–3:00PM)		

5 Values

5.1 Academic Honesty Policy Statement

Since the integrity of the academic enterprise of any institution of higher education requires honesty in scholarship and research, academic honesty is required of all students at the University of Massachusetts Amherst. Academic dishonesty including but not limited to cheating, fabrication, plagiarism, and facilitating dishonesty, is prohibited in all programs of the University. Appropriate sanctions may be imposed on any student who has committed an act of academic dishonesty. Instructors should take reasonable steps to address academic misconduct. Any person who has reason to believe that a student has committed academic dishonesty should bring such information to the attention of the appropriate course instructor as soon as possible. Instances of academic dishonesty not related to a specific course should be brought to the attention of the appropriate department Head or Chair. The procedures outlined below are intended to provide an efficient and orderly process by which action may be taken if it appears that academic dishonesty has occurred and by which students may appeal such actions. Since students are expected to be familiar with this policy and the commonly accepted standards of academic integrity, ignorance of such standards is not normally sufficient evidence of lack of intent. For more information about what constitutes academic dishonesty, please see the Dean of Students' website: http://umass.edu/dean_students/honesty/

5.2 Disability Statement

The University of Massachusetts Amherst is committed to making reasonable, effective and appropriate accommodations to meet the needs of students with disabilities and help create a barrier-free campus. If you are in need of accommodation for a documented disability, register with Disability Services to have an accommodation letter sent to your faculty. It is your responsibility to initiate these services and to communicate with faculty ahead of time to manage accommodations in a timely manner. For more information, consult the Disability Services website at <http://www.umass.edu/disability/>.

5.3 Title IX

In accordance with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 that prohibits gender-based discrimination in educational settings that receive federal funds, the University of Massachusetts Amherst is committed to providing a safe learning environment for all students, free from all forms of discrimination, including sexual assault, sexual harassment, domestic violence, dating violence, stalking, and retaliation. This includes interactions in person or online through digital platforms and social media. Title IX also protects against discrimination on the basis of pregnancy, childbirth, false pregnancy, miscarriage, abortion, or related conditions, including recovery. There are resources here on campus to support you. A summary of the available Title IX resources (confidential and non-confidential) can be found at the following link: <https://www.umass.edu/titleix/resources>. You do not need to make a formal report to access them. If you need immediate support, you are not alone. Free and confidential support is available 24 hours a day/7 days a week/365 days a year at the SASA Hotline 413-545-0800.

5.4 Policy Against Discrimination, Harassment, and Related Interpersonal Violence

In synergy with the aspirations of our department and the college, I strive to ensure that my classroom is a place where all students can not only succeed, but also thrive. Federal and state laws as well as University policies provide several protections to support these efforts.

The University of Massachusetts Amherst, through this Policy Against Discrimination, Harassment, and Related Interpersonal Violence prohibits unlawful discrimination, harassment, and retaliation on the basis of race, color, religion, caste, creed, sex, sex stereotypes, sex characteristics, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, pregnancy and pregnancy-related condition(s), age, marital status, national origin, mental or physical disability, political belief or affiliation, veteran status, genetic information, natural and protective hairstyle, and any other legally protected class of individuals protected from discrimination under state or federal law in any aspect of the access to, admission, employment, or treatment in the University's educational program and activity. The University affirms its commitment to provide a welcoming and respectful work and educational environment, in which all individuals within the University community may benefit from each other's experiences and foster mutual respect and appreciation of divergent views. Any member of the campus community, guest, or other person who acts to deny or limit the access to educational, employment, residential, and/or social programs or activities, benefits, and/or opportunities of any (other) member of the campus community, guest, or visitor on the basis of their actual or perceived membership in classes protected by this Policy will be in violation of this Policy.

6 Wellness and Success

You are not alone at UMass—many people care about your well-being and many resources are available to help you thrive and succeed. During this time, you may be experiencing pressures related to as health, money, family, and academic concerns or stress and trauma from societal inequities and violence. Coursework is challenging and classes are not the only demand in your life. You have resilience and are already using effective strategies to help you achieve your educational goals. Take stock of these and consider what new steps or resources could be helpful. Getting enough sleep, exercising, eating well, and connecting with others are all antidotes to stress. If you are struggling academically, reach out to your instructors and advisors prior to deadlines and before the demands of exams, papers, and projects reach their peak. Students experiencing challenges including stress, anxiety, difficulty concentrating, loneliness, and trauma, or who feel down or alienated, can find it helpful to connect with one or more of the many supportive resources on campus that stand ready to assist you. You matter at UMass.

6.1 Academic Advice and Support

- Academic Dean: <https://www.umass.edu/registrar/students/list-academic-deans>
- Academic Advisor: <https://www.umass.edu/gateway/academics/academic-advising>
- Writing Center: <https://www.umass.edu/writingcenter/>
- Learning Resource Center: <https://www.umass.edu/lrc/>

6.2 Single-Stop Resources

- Referrals for personal, financial, or life challenges that interfere with college success and well-being: <http://www.umass.edu/studentlife/single-stop>

6.3 Communities of Support

- Residential Life Support for on campus students; help addressing roommate disputes and residence hall quality of life: <https://www.umass.edu/living/>
- Off Campus Student Life (OCSL): <https://www.umass.edu/offcampuslife/>; (413) 577-1005
Community connections and programs for students living off-campus
- International Programs Office (IPO): <https://www.umass.edu/ipo/>; (413) 545-2710
Networking and assistance for international students and scholars at UMass and UMass students studying abroad
- Center for Multicultural Advancement and Student Success (CMASS): <https://www.umass.edu/cmss/>; (413) 545-2517
Mentoring, workshops, advocacy, scholarship and internship opportunities, graduate school preparation and career development
- Stonewall Center: <https://www.umass.edu/stonewall/>; (413) 545-4824
Programming, advocacy, and support for LGBTQIA+ students and allies
- Student Parent Programs: <https://www.umass.edu/ofr/>; (413) 545-0865
Support for students with children
- Student Veteran Resource Center:
<https://www.umass.edu/veterans/student-veteran-resource-center-svrc/>; (413) 545-0939
A welcoming place for veterans, active military members, and their families to study, network, learn, seek support, and get help with benefits
- Center for Women and Community: <https://www.umass.edu/cwc/>; (413) 545-0883
Information and referrals, community education, general counseling, and empowerment-based support groups for survivors of all genders
- Men and Masculinities Center: <https://www.umass.edu/masculinities/>; (413) 577-4636
Supports male student success and the development of healthy masculinities
- Office of Religious and Spiritual Life: <https://www.umass.edu/orsl/>; (413) 545-9642
Educational programs, advocacy, dialogue, interfaith programs and service
- Center for Health Promotion: <https://www.umass.edu/studentlife/health-safety/chp/>; (413) 577-5181
Peer wellness coaching, alcohol screening and brief intervention, support for students in recovery

6.4 Offices that Can Help

- Center for Counseling and Psychological Health: <https://www.umass.edu/counseling/> (413) 545-2337. After hours: (877) 831-7421
24/7 emergency crisis intervention, support groups and workshops, online therapy and resources, brief psychotherapy and referrals
- Dean of Students Office: https://www.umass.edu/dean_students/ (413) 545-2684
Advice and support for managing challenging or crisis related matters
- UMass Police Department: <https://www.umass.edu/umpd/> (413) 545-2121. Emergency: (413) 545-3111 or 911
Immediate emergency response, anonymous tip reporting, theft prevention, community safety, and self-defense programs and training
- University Health Services: <https://www.umass.edu/uhs/> (413) 577-5000
24/7 medical advice and triage, walk-in clinic, nutritional counseling, sports medicine, and more
- Disability Services: <https://www.umass.edu/disability/> (413) 545-0892
Help registering and accommodating students with all types of disabilities
- Student Legal Services Office: <https://www.umass.edu/slso/> (413) 545-1995
Confidential legal counseling and advice for all fee-paying students with any legal matter
- Psychological Services Center: <https://www.umass.edu/psc/> (413) 545-0041
Individual, couples and group therapy and assessment services
- Ombuds Office: <https://www.umass.edu/ombuds/> (413) 545-0867
Facilitation and informal mediation; resolution of grade disputes
- Equal Opportunity Office: <https://www.umass.edu/equalopportunity/> (413) 545-3464
Upholds university's commitment to access and opportunity for all